



Niccolò Machiavelli

The second citizen was Niccolò Machiavelli, Florence's most talented negotiator and spy. He thought Borgia might not be as intent on conquering Florence as he appeared and could be persuaded to spare the city.

The plan worked.

Borgia agreed not to attack and enlisted Leonardo's help with his military campaign. By nature, Leonardo was a peaceful man, but he was also a practical one. If working for Cesare Borgia would be both profitable and allow him to pursue his interests, then he would keep his personal views about war to himself.

